



**Official Rulebook**  
**Champion of Champions Tour CS2**  
**2026**

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# Table of Contents

|                                                          |           |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>1. Definitions</b>                                    | <b>4</b>  |
| <b>2. General Information</b>                            | <b>4</b>  |
| 2.1. Changes to the Rules                                | 4         |
| 2.2. Compliance                                          | 4         |
| 2.3. Valve Tournament Operating Requirements             | 5         |
| <b>3. Tournament Information</b>                         | <b>5</b>  |
| 3.1. Tournament Format                                   | 5         |
| 3.2. VRS Invites                                         | 7         |
| 3.3. Invite Date                                         | 8         |
| 3.4. Team Replacements                                   | 8         |
| 3.5. Wildcard Slots                                      | 9         |
| 3.6. Open Qualifier Slots                                | 9         |
| 3.7. Seed VRS                                            | 9         |
| 3.8. Regions                                             | 9         |
| 3.9. Team Location                                       | 9         |
| 3.10. Publisher's Rights                                 | 10        |
| 3.11. Communication                                      | 10        |
| 3.12. Prize Money                                        | 10        |
| 3.12. Match Broadcasting                                 | 11        |
| 3.12.1. Rights                                           | 11        |
| 3.12.2. Waiving these Rights                             | 11        |
| 3.12.3. Protection of Rights                             | 12        |
| 3.12.4. Teams' Compliance                                | 12        |
| 3.13. Betting on Matches                                 | 12        |
| 3.14. Roster Eligibility                                 | 12        |
| 3.15. Team Commitment & Withdrawals                      | 12        |
| <b>4. Participation in CCT</b>                           | <b>12</b> |
| 4.1. Age                                                 | 12        |
| 4.2. Game Accounts                                       | 13        |
| 4.3 Invite Exceptions                                    | 13        |
| 4.3.1 Integrity-Based Participation Restrictions         | 13        |
| 4.3.2 Team Participation Agreement and Deemed Acceptance | 16        |
| 4.4. Team Participation Agreement (TPA)                  | 16        |
| 4.5. Team Roster Submission                              | 17        |
| 4.5.1 Team Roster Submission                             | 17        |
| 4.6. Team Rosters                                        | 17        |
| 4.7. Roster Updates in between CCT Events                | 18        |
| 4.8. Stand-in Rules                                      | 18        |
| 4.8.1 Emergency Stand-in Rules                           | 18        |
| 4.9. Multiple Contracts                                  | 19        |
| 4.10. Coaches                                            | 19        |
| 4.11. Nicknames                                          | 20        |
| 4.12. Team Names                                         | 20        |
| 4.13. Team Photos and Logotypes                          | 21        |
| 4.14. Media Obligations                                  | 21        |
| 4.14.1 Camera Obligations                                | 21        |
| 4.14.2 Camera Setup Guidelines                           | 21        |
| 4.14.3 Integrity Requirements                            | 22        |
| 4.14.4 Penalties                                         | 22        |

|                                                 |    |
|-------------------------------------------------|----|
| 4.15 Schedule Requests                          | 23 |
| 4.15.1. Schedule Request Timing                 | 23 |
| 4.15.2. Schedule Request Compliance             | 23 |
| 4.16. Matches                                   | 24 |
| 4.16.1. Punctuality                             | 24 |
| 4.16.2. Delaying the Match                      | 24 |
| 4.16.3 Technical Problems during the Match      | 25 |
| 4.16.4. Restarting a map                        | 25 |
| 4.16.5. Forfeiting a match                      | 26 |
| 4.17. Team Sponsorships                         | 26 |
| 5. Game-specific Rules                          | 26 |
| 5.1. Server settings                            | 26 |
| 5.2. Match Platform                             | 27 |
| 5.2.1. Game Server Location                     | 27 |
| 5.2.2. Available Server Commands                | 27 |
| 5.3. Map Pool                                   | 27 |
| 5.3.1. Maps                                     | 27 |
| 5.4. Map Selection                              | 27 |
| 5.4.1. Best-Of-One Map Veto                     | 28 |
| 5.4.2. Best-Of-Three Map Veto                   | 28 |
| 5.4.3. Best-Of-Five Map Veto                    | 28 |
| 5.5. In-game Behavior                           | 28 |
| 5.5.1. Forbidden Scripts and In-game Actions    | 28 |
| 5.5.2. Issues during the Match                  | 29 |
| 5.5.3. Recordings                               | 29 |
| 5.5.4. Anti-Cheat Ban                           | 30 |
| 5.5.5. Anti-Cheat                               | 30 |
| 6. Penalties and Warnings                       | 30 |
| 6.1. Warnings                                   | 30 |
| 6.2. Major Warnings and Disqualification        | 31 |
| 6.3. Forfeiting the Veto                        | 31 |
| 6.4. Penalties and Consequences for leaving CCT | 32 |
| 6.4.1. Leaving during any phase                 | 32 |
| 6.4.2. Forfeiture of Matches                    | 32 |
| 7. Code of Conduct                              | 32 |
| 7.1. Competitive Integrity                      | 32 |
| 7.1.1. Collusion                                | 32 |
| 7.1.2. Cheating and Exploiting                  | 32 |
| 7.2. Responsibility under the Code              | 33 |
| 7.3. Employment and Contract Conduct            | 33 |
| 7.4. Match and Game Integrity                   | 33 |
| Annex 1                                         | 33 |

# 1. Definitions

- **CCT:** The Champion of Champions Tour, a series of CS2 competitions
- **Participants:** Teams and players who participate in the CCT
- **Tournament Organizer (TO):** The organization responsible for organizing and operating the CCT event (CCT & GAM3RS\_X)
- **Tournament Official:** Referees and other Officials involved in operating the CCT
- **CCT Partners or Partners:** Organizations that are involved with and supportive of the CCT
- **Regions:** The geographic areas that the CCT events are held in
- **CCT Events or Events:** Specific tournaments or competitions that make up the Tour
- **Counter-Strike 2 (CS2):** The game title utilised for the competition
- **Publisher's Rights:** The rights held by the game publisher (Valve) in relation to the CCT
- **Communication:** The means of communication used by the Tournament Officials, participants, and partners, such as email, chat, or voice communication
- **Prize Money:** The monetary rewards given to the winning teams of the CCT event
- **Match Broadcasting:** The broadcasting of CCT matches through online platforms such as streaming services
- **Rights:** The rights held by the CCT in relation to the broadcasting and promotion of CCT matches
- **Valve Corporation (Valve):** The publisher of Counter-Strike 2 (CS2).
- **Valve Regional Standings (VRS):** The official system for ranking the performance of Rosters published by Valve, provided for the respective regions and applied at the designated Invite Date
- **Valve Tournament Operating Requirements (TOR):** The official requirements to operate any event in the Counter-Strike 2 (CS2) ecosystem, created and operated by Valve.

## 2. General Information

This document outlines the rules that should at all times be followed when participating in the Champion of Champions Tour CS2. Failure to adhere to these rules may result in penalties.

Fair play, competitive integrity, and respect for the game are core pillars of CCT and will be upheld throughout the season in line with these rules.

### 2.1. Changes to the Rules

The Tournament Officials reserve the right to amend, update, or clarify any part of this rulebook at any time before or during the tournament if deemed reasonably necessary. This includes, but is not limited to, addressing unforeseen situations or ensuring competitive integrity.

Decisions made by Tournament Officials may override specific rules when required, based on their best judgement and the information available at the time.

### 2.2. Compliance

By participating in the tournament, all players and team staff unconditionally accept the rules outlined in this document. Furthermore, they acknowledge that any decision made by the Tournament Officials during the event may supersede the written regulations when necessary. **Whether or not the Team has executed a Team Participation Agreement ("TPA"), participation by the Team or any member of its player roster in a CCT Event shall constitute deemed acceptance of the terms of the TPA and this Rulebook by the Team and each participating player.** All participants acknowledge CCT's Privacy Policy, available at [cctour.gg](https://cctour.gg), which governs the processing of personal data in connection with the CCT.

Any concerns regarding the tournament integrity, including (but not limited to) suspected cheating, match-fixing, account sharing, etc may be submitted to [support@cct.gg](mailto:support@cct.gg).

## 2.3. Valve Tournament Operating Requirements

The CCT is operated in compliance with [Valve's Tournament Operating Requirements](#) (Valve's TOR), according to regulations set out for Tier 2 Events.

The tournament format of each Regional Series may be adjusted at the discretion of the TO. The exact format and schedule will be communicated directly to invited teams prior to each competition.

As required by Valve's TOR, all Event Additional Information will be published on [cctour.gg](https://cctour.gg), with updates and official statements shared via [CCT's X account](#).

# 3. Tournament Information

## 3.1. Tournament Format

The format of the CCT Events is described below:

| 2026 Europe Series 1, 2, 3, 8, 10, 11, 13, 14 |                                       |                                                                 |                               |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Event Stage                                   | # Teams                               | Format                                                          | # of Winners                  |
| Play-Ins                                      | 16 Teams<br>16 Invited Teams          | 4x GSL Groups +<br>Single-Elimination<br>Decider<br>Bo3 Matches | 4 teams advance to next stage |
| Group Stage                                   | 16 Teams<br>4 Qualified<br>12 Invited | Swiss<br>Bo3 Matches                                            | 8 teams advance to next stage |
| Playoffs                                      | 16 Teams<br>8 Qualified<br>8 Invited  | Single-Elimination<br>Bracket<br>Bo3 Matches                    | 8 prize money winners         |

| 2026 Europe Series 4, 5, 6, 7, 9, 12, 15, 16 |         |        |              |
|----------------------------------------------|---------|--------|--------------|
| Event Stage                                  | # Teams | Format | # of Winners |

|             |                                                                                             |                                                                 |                               |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Play-Ins    | 16 Teams<br>14 Invited Teams<br>2 Wildcard Teams (Finalists of CCT 2026 Challengers Europe) | 4x GSL Groups +<br>Single-Elimination<br>Decider<br>Bo3 Matches | 4 teams advance to next stage |
| Group Stage | 16 Teams<br>4 Qualified<br>12 Invited                                                       | Swiss<br>Bo3 Matches                                            | 8 teams advance to next stage |
| Playoffs    | 16 Teams<br>8 Qualified<br>8 Invited                                                        | Single-Elimination<br>Bracket<br>Bo3 Matches                    | 8 prize money winners         |

| 2026 South America |                                                        |                                              |                               |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Event Stage        | # Teams                                                | Format                                       | # Winners                     |
| Group Stage        | 16 Teams<br>14 Invited Teams<br>2 Open Qualifier Teams | Swiss<br>Bo3 Matches                         | 8 teams advance to next stage |
| Playoffs           | 16 Teams<br>8 Qualified<br>8 Invited                   | Single-Elimination<br>Bracket<br>Bo3 Matches | 8 prize money winners         |

| 2026 Contenders Europe 1, 2, 3 & 4 |                                     |                                              |                       |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Event Stage                        | # Teams                             | Format                                       | # of Winners          |
| Main Event                         | 16 Teams<br>16 Open Qualifier Teams | Double-Elimination<br>Bracket<br>Bo3 Matches | 3 prize money winners |

| 2026 Contenders Europe 5, 6, 7, 8, 9 & 10 |                                                        |                                              |                       |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Event Stage                               | # Teams                                                | Format                                       | # of Winners          |
| Main Event                                | 16 Teams<br>14 Invited Teams<br>2 Open Qualifier Teams | Double-Elimination<br>Bracket<br>Bo3 Matches | 3 prize money winners |

| 2026 Challengers Europe |                                                                                                   |                                              |                       |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Event Stage             | # Teams                                                                                           | Format                                       | # of Winners          |
| Main Event              | 16 Teams<br>14 Invited Teams<br>2 Wildcard Teams (Finalists of CCT 2026 Contenders Europe 2 to 9) | Double-Elimination<br>Bracket<br>Bo3 Matches | 3 prize money winners |

| 2026 Challengers South America |         |        |              |
|--------------------------------|---------|--------|--------------|
| Event Stage                    | # Teams | Format | # of Winners |

|            |                                                        |                                              |                       |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Main Event | 16 Teams<br>14 Invited Teams<br>2 Open Qualifier Teams | Double-Elimination<br>Bracket<br>Bo3 Matches | 3 prize money winners |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|

CCT reserves the right to add Open Qualifiers to any Champion of Champions Tour Event by announcing it on [cctour.gg](https://cctour.gg) with the Event Additional Information, as per the Valve TOR.

### 3.2. VRS Invites

| CCT Event Region                              | VRS Region & Sub-Lists                                          | Starting Rank          | # Slots    |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|------------|
| 2026 Europe Series 1, 2, 3, 8, 10, 11, 13, 14 | Europe VRS                                                      | Starting from Rank 9   | 36 invites |
| 2026 Europe Series 4, 5, 6, 7, 9, 12, 15, 16  | Europe VRS                                                      | Starting from Rank 9   | 34 invites |
|                                               | Wildcard Teams (Finalists of CCT 2026 Challengers Europe)       | –                      | 2 invites  |
| 2026 South America Series                     | Americas VRS with country filter: South America (see Annex 1)   | Starting from Rank 1   | 22 invites |
|                                               | Open Qualifier Winners                                          | –                      | 2 invites  |
| 2026 Contenders Europe 1, 2, 3 & 4            | Open Qualifier Winners                                          | –                      | 16 Slots   |
| 2026 Contenders Europe 5, 6, 7, 8, 9 & 10     | Europe VRS                                                      | Starting from Rank 120 | 14 invites |
|                                               | Open Qualifier Winners                                          | –                      | 2 Slots    |
| 2026 Challengers Europe                       | Europe VRS                                                      | Starting from Rank 100 | 14 invites |
|                                               | Wildcard Teams (Finalists of CCT 2026 Contenders Europe 2 to 9) | –                      | 2 invites  |
| 2026 Challengers South America                | Americas VRS with country filter: South America (see Annex 1)   | Starting from Rank 16  | 14 Slots   |

|  |                        |   |         |
|--|------------------------|---|---------|
|  | Open Qualifier Winners | - | 2 Slots |
|--|------------------------|---|---------|

If the number of eligible VRS Teams is lower than the total number of Direct VRS Invite slots, the CCT reserves the right to reallocate any unfilled slot(s) to Open Qualifiers. This reallocation may apply to any Event and will be announced on [CCT's X Account](#) prior to the event.

### 3.3. Invite Date

The Invite Date for each event will be announced individually, with a minimum lead time of two months prior to the event start date.

- Invited teams will have 72 hours to confirm participation. Failure to respond within this window will be considered a declined invitation, unless an exception is granted by Tournament Officials.
- Teams are responsible for keeping the Tournament Officials informed of any changes to primary contact details to ensure timely delivery of invites.

In line with Valve's Tournament Operating Requirements, the Invite Date, Valve-Required Submission (VRS) Dates, and Invite Breakdown will be published on [cctour.gg](#), along with the event's Additional Information.

### 3.4. Team Replacements

In the event a team withdraws or is unable to participate, CCT will prioritize replacing the team using the same invite method and filter originally applied to the slot:

- Invite VRS - The next highest-ranked eligible team, using the same Invite VRS filter, will be selected.
- Qualified by Open Qualifier - The team that lost to the withdrawn team in the most recent qualifier may be invited to replace them.
- Wildcard - If the slot was originally a Wildcard and no direct replacement is available, CCT reserves the right to convert the Wildcard into an Invite VRS slot, applying the announced Invite VRS filters.

If the withdrawn team did not qualify via Open Qualifier and no eligible Invite VRS team is available, the following logic will apply:

- CCT may nominate a team from the most recent Open Qualifier (if one was held).
- In cases where multiple teams are eligible or in contention, CCT reserves the right to:
  - Schedule additional decider matches between next-in-line teams, or
  - Follow the original qualifier bracket structure to determine the appropriate replacement.



CCT reserves the right to deny or cancel any replacement if it is deemed to compromise the competitive integrity, schedule, or flow of the event. In such cases, the original team will remain in the bracket, and any unplayed matches will be forfeited until their official elimination.

### **3.5. Wildcard Slots**

Wildcard eligibility will be confirmed according to the Valve Tournament Operation Requirements. In case the Wildcard Slot will not be utilized, we may invite the next highest ranked Rosters from the VRS lists already announced for the Tournament.

The assignment of any Wildcard Invite is at the sole discretion of CCT, regardless of VRS ranking or prior participation.

### **3.6. Open Qualifier Slots**

Any team that qualifies through Open Qualifiers must be fully eligible to compete in the regional event, in line with Valve's Tournament Operating Requirements and the CCT Rulebook. This includes:

1. The core roster, for all matches, must currently reside in the region they are competing in.
2. The core roster used to qualify (at least 3 of the 5 players) must be maintained for all starting matches of the regional event.
3. Any changes to the qualified roster must be pre-approved by Tournament Officials.

Teams that don't meet these requirements may be disqualified or replaced without further notice.

### **3.7. Seed VRS**

The Seed VRS will be announced on a per event basis, with the Event Additional Information, on [cctour.gg](http://cctour.gg).

### **3.8. Regions**

CCT Series will be held for the following regions:

- South America
- Europe

For the specific countries within each region please check Annex 1.

### **3.9. Team Location**

Teams are required to remain located within the Event Region for the entire duration of the competition to ensure fair conditions and consistent ping for all participants.

For clarity, all players participating in the CCT Event must be based in the regions listed in Annex 1 for every match. CCT may, at its sole discretion, approve exceptions to this residency requirement following a good-faith review of a team's specific circumstances.

### 3.10. Publisher's Rights

The Publisher (Valve) reserves the right to remove any player or team from the tournament for any reason. In such a case, the player or team will be disqualified.

### 3.11. Communication

All official communication between participants and the Tournament Organizer will take place via Discord. A dedicated server will be used to coordinate with team captains, managers, and other relevant team members from all participating teams.

- Teams are responsible for actively monitoring Discord for match updates, scheduling, and tournament announcements.
- Each team must ensure at least one representative has joined the official Discord server prior to their first CCT match.
- CCT reserves the right to remove any participant from the Discord server for violations of tournament rules or disruptive behavior.

Join the [CCT 2026 Europe](#) Server here.

Join the [CCT 2026 Contenders Europe, Challengers Europe & South America Discord](#) Server here.

### 3.12. Prize Money

The prize pool and its distribution for the CCT Series is described below.

#### Regional Series (Per Series) - 2026

| Placement                              | 2026 Europe | 2026 South America | Challengers Europe                | Contenders Europe 1 + 10 | Contenders Europe 2 to 8                      | Challengers South America |
|----------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1 <sup>st</sup> Place                  | \$10,000    | \$7,500            | \$3,000 + Slot on CCT 2026 Europe | \$1,250                  | \$1,250 + Slot on CCT 2026 Challengers Europe | \$1,250                   |
| 2 <sup>nd</sup> Place                  | \$5,000     | \$4,000            | \$1,500 + Slot on CCT 2026 Europe | \$750                    | \$750 + Slot on CCT 2026 Challengers Europe   | \$750                     |
| 3 <sup>rd</sup> Place                  | \$2,500     | \$1,750            | \$500                             | \$500                    | \$500                                         | \$500                     |
| 4 <sup>th</sup> Place                  | \$2,500     | \$1,750            | -                                 | -                        | -                                             | -                         |
| 5 <sup>th</sup> -8 <sup>th</sup> Place | \$1,250     | -                  | -                                 | -                        | -                                             | -                         |
| Total                                  | \$25,000    | \$15,000           | \$5,000 + 2x Slot on CCT 2026     | \$2,500                  | \$2,500 + 2x Slot on CCT 2026                 | \$2,500                   |

|  |  |  |        |  |                       |  |
|--|--|--|--------|--|-----------------------|--|
|  |  |  | Europe |  | Challengers<br>Europe |  |
|--|--|--|--------|--|-----------------------|--|

All teams are required to review and sign Team Participation Agreements (TPA) in order to be eligible to participate in the CCT and to receive CCT prize payments.

Prize money will be paid out after receipt of a valid invoice, within the payment tranche following the conclusion of the respective CCT Series, as described in the Team Participation Agreement, following the attached table:

| Quarterly Payment Run | Events Finishing        | Invoice Receipt Period Opener | Invoice Receipt Period Closed | Payment Terms Deadline |
|-----------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------|
| Payment Cycle Q1-Y    | Nov 1, Y-1 to Jan 31, Y | 01.02.Y                       | 15.02.Y                       | 01.03.Y                |
| Payment Cycle Q2-Y    | Feb 1, Y to April 30, Y | 01.05.Y                       | 15.05.Y                       | 01.06.Y                |
| Payment Cycle Q3-Y    | May 1 to July 31, Y     | 01.08.Y                       | 05.08.Y                       | 01.09.Y                |
| Payment Cycle Q4-Y    | Aug 1 to Oct 31, Y      | 01.11.Y                       | 15.11.Y                       | 01.12.Y                |

Participants are obligated to provide a valid invoice as designated by Tournament Officials, in order to receive prize money. Failure to provide a valid invoice may result in delayed receipt of prize money funds. Invoice Guidelines and clauses are detailed on the Team Participation Agreement.

When a team organisation ceases to exist, individual team members that are owed prize money may claim their prize money up to three (3) years following the conclusion of the respective event. In this case, the roster must designate one (1) representative to act on the group's behalf.

For any questions related to Payment Cycles or Prize-Moneys please contact [prizemoney@cct.gg](mailto:prizemoney@cct.gg).

### **3.12. Match Broadcasting**

#### **3.12.1. Rights**

All of the broadcasting rights of CCT are owned by GRID eSports GmbH.

This includes, but is not limited to: Broadcast streams, video streams, podcast streams, radio streams, GOTV, replays, demos, and TV Broadcasts.

By participating in the CCT, each team and team member consents that their likeness (logo, voice, image, name, nickname, etc) are recorded and broadcasted live and on demand on streaming platforms designated by the organizer.

The CCT retains the rights to utilizing all CCT footage at its own discretion.

#### **3.12.2. Waiving these Rights**

GRID and its partners have the right to award broadcasting rights for one or multiple matches to a third party. Participants themselves are not allowed to stream or broadcast their matches.

### **3.12.3. Protection of Rights**

The tournament organizer has the right to protect its own products created during or after the tournament from rebroadcast or unauthorized usage in post-production.

### **3.12.4. Teams' Compliance**

Teams may not refuse to have their matches broadcasted by GRID authorized broadcasts, nor can they choose in what manner the match will be broadcasted. The broadcast can only be rejected by the Tournament Officials. The teams agree to cooperate so that the broadcasting of matches can take place.

### **3.13. Betting on Matches**

No players, team managers, staff, or management of attending organizations can place any bets on or be involved in betting or gambling, associate with betters or gamblers, or provide any third party with information that may assist betting or gambling, either directly or indirectly for any CCT matches or the CCT tournament series.

### **3.14. Roster Eligibility**

If a roster is unable to participate, fails to respond within 72 hours of receipt of an invite or chooses to decline a direct VRS Invite, the invite will be extended to the next roster in order of the VRS, with respective filters applied (if any), until all tournament slots are filled.

Teams that accept a VRS Invite must maintain at least three (3) out of five (5) players from the VRS Core Roster used to secure the invite. This requirement applies to all matches in the tournament. Failure to meet this condition may result in the team being replaced or disqualified at the discretion of Tournament Officials.

### **3.15. Team Commitment & Withdrawals**

Once a team has confirmed its participation in a CCT event, CCT reserves the right to deny any withdrawal requests. Any team attempting to withdraw before being officially eliminated from the tournament may be subject to automatic match forfeits.

In accordance with Valve's TOR, forfeiting a match may result in the loss of VRS Points. CCT bears no responsibility for any penalties, point deductions, or eligibility consequences arising from forfeits, as these are enforced by Valve.

Teams are expected to fulfill their tournament commitments in full once participation is confirmed. Forfeiting matches or withdrawing may also impact a team's eligibility for future CCT invitations.

## **4. Participation in CCT**

### **4.1. Age**

All participants must have reached the age of 16 to be eligible. To participate in the CCT, the team must provide player roster information including date of birth as set out in the Team Roster Submission and Team Participation Agreement.

## **4.2. Game Accounts**

Players must register one Steam account per player and submit their SteamIDs to the Tournament Officials before the tournament. Participants may only use Steam accounts during the tournament that were registered in this manner. In case of account issues, Participants agree to inform Tournament Officials ahead of time.

## **4.3 Invite Exceptions**

Pursuant to Section 5.4 of Valve's [Tournament Operation Requirements](#) ("TOR"), CCT will decline to invite or may disqualify participants from CCT Events for misconduct, cheating infractions, being flagged by esports bodies as a matchmaking fix risk, or other integrity or compliance issues.

CCT will decline participation, where one of the following criteria are met:

- **Invite Exception 1:** Rulebook violations and/or misconduct.
- **Invite Exception 2:** Team and/or player(s) are subject to a ban for integrity concerns by third party esports bodies (such as ESIC); or the team is subject to an active integrity flag which identifies a risk to the integrity of the competition by third party esports bodies or Valve, or the team is subject to a ban or restriction imposed by Valve.
- **Invite Exception 3:** The core team roster (at least 3 players) differs from the roster published in the designated version of the VRS used on the Invite Date.
- **Invite Exception 4:** One organization fields multiple rosters that are eligible to receive an invite according to the designated version of the VRS on the Invite Date, e.g. a Main and an Academy roster. In this case, the organisation may choose one (1) roster to accept the invite.
- **Invite Exception 5:** One or more players, including stand-ins, is under 16 years old.
- **Invite Exception 6:** The Team is subject to an integrity-based restriction as per section 4.3.1.
- **Invite Exception 7:** The team submits a roster that includes a player with an active suspension.
- **Invite Exception 8:** The Team has not signed or withdrawn from the TPA by written notice to CCT under Section 4.3.2 of this Rulebook.

Where an invite is withheld or revoked under this Section 4.3, CCT will publicly communicate only the fact of ineligibility and the applicable Invite Exception, without disclosing sensitive personal information.

### **4.3.1 Integrity-Based Participation Restrictions**

CCT will apply Invite Exception 6 where an Integrity Assessment under this Section 4.3.1 determines that the criteria in Sections 4.3.1 (a) to (c) are met.

For the purposes of this Section 4.3.1, Integrity Assessments and related monitoring are conducted by GRID Integrity on behalf of CCT. An Integrity Assessment under this Section is an eligibility assessment for tournament participation only and does not constitute a finding of civil, criminal, or disciplinary liability. No decision under this section shall be construed as implying guilt or wrongdoing on the part of any team, player, or individual. CCT and GRID Integrity act in the legitimate interest of protecting the competitive integrity of the CCT.

#### (a) Triggering Event

An Integrity Assessment will be initiated where a suspicious betting market (in CCT or any other GRID-partnered event) relating to the Team is reported by:

- A licensed betting operator;
- A betting supplier;
- A recognised integrity body; or
- GRID Integrity's monitoring systems;

For the purposes of this Section, each of the above shall constitute a recognised integrity source.

NB: GRID and CCT do not consent or endorse the reliance on the application of any Invite Exception by any third party organiser, publisher or person based on the Invite Exceptions made by CCT. Any such application is made independently, and GRID and CCT shall have no liability to any team, player, or related third party arising from it.

#### (b) Remoteness and Corroboration

Invite Exception 6 will not apply solely on the basis of a report from a single source. Invite Exception 6 applies under this Section only where materially similar suspicious activity is independently reported or confirmed by at least one additional recognised integrity source.

#### (c) Supporting Factors

In determining whether Invite Exception 6 shall be applied, CCT will consider additional supporting elements, including but not limited to:

- Historical integrity reports involving the team or its players;
- Evidence of players or team members betting on their own matches;
- Prior blacklisting or suspension by recognised betting or integrity bodies;
- Credible internal or public reports from opposing teams;
- The team or one of its member has admitted conduct inconsistent with the competitive integrity requirements of this Rulebook; or
- The team has refused to comply with an integrity measure expressly required under this Rulebook;

#### (d) Outcomes

Following the Integrity Assessment from GRID Integrity and where Invite Exception 6 is applied, CCT shall act reasonably and in compliance with Valve's Tournament Operation Requirements and the TPA, as follows:

- During the invite phase: The Team will not receive an invite;
- After an invite was extended: Revoke the Team's invite prior to Event start;
- During the event: Remove (disqualify) the team from the current Event, where the Team will forfeit all matches;

(e) Suspensions

| <b>Invite Exception</b> | <b>Description</b>               | <b>Duration of Suspension</b>                            |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Invite Exception 1      | Rulebook Violation or Misconduct | One (1) CCT Event                                        |
| Invite Exception 2      | Third Party Integrity Flag       | Until the Third Party Flag is lifted                     |
| Invite Exception 3      | Core Roster                      | One (1) CCT Event                                        |
| Invite Exception 4      | Multiple Rosters                 | One (1) CCT Event                                        |
| Invite Exception 5      | Under 16 y/o                     | One (1) CCT Event, or until the Player turns 16.         |
| Invite Exception 6      | Integrity Restriction            | 18 Months, unless lifted earlier under Section 4.3.1 (h) |
| Invite Exception 7      | Active Player Suspension         | One (1) CCT Event                                        |
| Invite Exception 8      | TPA                              | One (1) CCT event or until the TPA is signed.            |

Suspensions apply to CCT Events only and to players that actively played in the respective Match(es) which triggered an Integrity Assessment.

Individual team members who were part of the playing roster that was suspended, may not participate in CCT with the same or different roster until the suspension expires.

(f) Publication

In line with TOR, CCT shall publicly communicate that an invite has been withheld or revoked, referencing the applicable Invite Exception.

[CCT - Invite Exceptions \(Public\)](#)

(g) Standard and Proportionality - Invite Exception 6

The application and publication of Invite Exception 6 is an eligibility determination only and does not constitute an allegation or finding of wrongdoing.

#### (h) Procedural Fairness and Interim Measures

CCT may impose a suspension pending completion of the assessment based on the risk assessment and under guidance from GRID Integrity. Reinstatement of a team shall depend on whether the circumstances set out in this 4.3 continue or are abated.

Where an Invite Exception 6 suspension of 18 months has been applied, the Team may, no earlier than 6 months from the date of the suspension, submit written representations to CCT regarding the continued application of the suspension. Upon receipt of such submissions, CCT shall, together with a recognised integrity partner, reassess whether the Team continues to present a material risk to competitive integrity. CCT shall notify the Team of its determination within 30 days of receipt of the submissions. For the avoidance of doubt, this reassessment does not constitute an appeal.

#### (i) Contacts

If you would like to reach out to CCT regarding this section 4.3, please contact: [integrity@cct.gg](mailto:integrity@cct.gg).

#### **4.3.2 Team Participation Agreement and Deemed Acceptance**

A Team's participation in any CCT Event is conditional upon the Team having executed a valid Team Participation Agreement ("TPA") for the current CCT season. The Team is responsible for ensuring that all Roster members and team staff comply with the terms of the TPA, the Rulebook, and the integrity framework.

**Whether or not the TPA has been executed, participation by the Team or any member of its player roster in a CCT Event shall constitute deemed acceptance of the terms of the TPA and this Rulebook by the Team and each participating player.** The Team Manager is responsible for ensuring that each player is made aware of, and understands, the terms of the TPA and the Rulebook prior to participation.

#### (a) Withdrawal

Upon withdrawal or failure to sign the TPA before a Team's first match in the respective CCT Event, Invite Exception 8 will apply to the Team.

#### **4.4. Team Participation Agreement (TPA)**

Participation in any CCT event is conditional upon the team having a valid and fully executed Team Participation Agreement (TPA), signed by an authorized team representative. Each team is required to complete the TPA once per Agreement Term, and no later than the conclusion of the team's participation in its first CCT event.

Failure to comply may result in suspension of the team (organization and/or roster) and/or withholding of prize money until such time as the TPA is properly executed. The TPA does not



obligate teams or players to participate in future events, and all information provided must be accurate and consistent with any subsequent invoicing details.

For all TPA related inquiries, please contact: [tpa@cct.gg](mailto:tpa@cct.gg).

#### **4.5. Team Roster Submission**

After accepting an invitation or qualifying for a CCT Event, teams will enter an Onboarding Period, during which they must complete a Team Roster Submission document. This document includes, but is not limited to:

- Team Information (Team Name, Short Name, Flag, X Account, Logo, Contacts)
- Up to eight (8) member profiles (Name, Nickname, Date of Birth, Steam ID, Player Picture, HLTV Profile)

A submission deadline will be communicated prior to the start of the Event. After this deadline, the document will be locked. Any changes thereafter require prior approval from CCT, which CCT reserves the right to approve or deny at its sole discretion.

CCT assumes no responsibility for outdated or incomplete submissions that may result in visual errors, incorrect information display, or team sponsor-related issues. Teams are solely responsible for ensuring that all information is accurate and submitted within the designated timeframe.

##### **4.5.1 Team Roster Submission**

Any changes requested after the Onboarding Period - including, but not limited to, adding stand-ins or updating player information, team names, or logos - may take up to seventy-two (72) hours to process across broadcast, social media, and related outputs.

Any requests should be submitted via Team Discord Channel.

All requests will be processed within CCT's operational timelines. Expedited processing is not guaranteed under any circumstances. Teams shall not expect or request immediate implementation of changes, regardless of match schedules or other external factors.

Repeated, urgent, or unreasonable attempts to expedite processing outside of CCT's operational timelines may result in disciplinary action, including warnings, at CCT's discretion.

#### **4.6. Team Rosters**

The total number of team members must not exceed 8 (including 5 players, 1 stand-in, a team manager, and a coach). All of the teams must fill out the form provided by CCT.

- No player transfers between teams will be allowed within the same Event.

- If a player participated in a single match for one team during a CCT Series, they will not be eligible to play for a different participating team in the same Series.

Any changes to the team must be approved by Tournament Officials before any upcoming match in a CCT Event. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Adding or removing players
- Changing the team name or team logo

#### **4.7. Roster Updates in between CCT Events**

Teams are allowed to make as many substitutes as they wish in between separate CCT events, while complying with the VRS Core Roster Rule. The teams must submit the updated roster to the TO as soon as possible. The Officials might reconsider team invites should the roster change be significant.

#### **4.8. Stand-in Rules**

Each team is permitted to register one (1) stand-in player for the event. The team coach may also serve as a stand-in, subject to all applicable rules outlined herein.

Stand-ins are eligible only if they have not participated for another team in the same Event. A stand-in must be approved by Tournament Officials at least 15 minutes prior to the start of the respective match.

All stand-ins must be officially registered with the team roster at least seventy-two (72) hours before participating in a match. Stand-ins may be registered either before the start of an Event or during the series, provided the 72-Hours notice period is respected.

Once a stand-in has played for a team in an Event, they are locked to that team for the duration of that series.

Roster changes, including the use of stand-ins, are not permitted mid-map (Map is ongoing). However, in-between maps roster changes are allowed.

The use of a stand-in must not violate the VRS Core Roster requirement. Each team must field a minimum of three (3) out of five (5) players from the VRS Core Roster associated with their VRS Invite in every match. Use of a stand-in that causes a team to fall below this threshold is not permitted and will result in a technical loss.

##### **4.8.1 Emergency Stand-in Rules**

In exceptional circumstances, a team may request approval for an emergency stand-in. Such requests may be submitted at any time, provided the team has an available stand-in slot. The request should be done via Team Discord Channel.

CCT reserves the right to approve or deny any emergency stand-in request at its sole discretion.

Due to the nature of such requests, CCT reserves the right to keep the request, its justification, and the reasoning for approval or denial confidential.

#### **4.9. Multiple Contracts**

Players must not have active playing contracts with two or more team organisations participating in an Event, written or oral.

If such a contract or agreement is found to be in place, the CCT reserves the right to suspend the player from participating in the Event until the contractual situation is resolved and approved by Tournament Officials. If the situation cannot be resolved, the CCT reserves the right to remove the player or team(s) in question.

Each organization and its legal entity may register only one team per Event. It is not permitted for a team to participate in a tournament, if another roster of the same organization has accepted an invite to a CCT Event.

#### **4.10. Coaches**

Teams are allowed to designate one individual as a coach during matches. The designated coach may step in as a stand-in in accordance with Rule 4.6, and must fully comply with all eligibility and registration requirements outlined therein. The coach will be considered a player and will follow any rules accordingly.

##### **4.10.1. Coach Communication during match**

To preserve competitive integrity Coaches may support their team during matches, but must do so within the limits set by CCT:

- Coaches may not be connected to the game server, but are allowed to join the team's voice communication channel (e.g. TeamSpeak).
- Communication is permitted during all moments of the game, provided it takes place on the official TeamSpeak. Any private communication channels, including voice or text (e.g., Discord, messaging apps), are strictly prohibited.
- All TeamSpeak sessions are recorded and stored for potential review.
- All communication must be directly related to the ongoing match and based solely on information available from the game server.
- If abuse is detected, CCT reserves the right to revoke communication privileges and apply disciplinary actions.

Abuse includes, but is not limited to:

- Providing information not obtainable through normal in-game play.
- Using third-party tools, livestreams, or external data sources to gain an advantage.
- Communicating with players outside the official TeamSpeak channel in any form (voice, text, or otherwise).

- Disruptive or excessive communication that interferes with fair play.

If communication privileges are revoked, coaches must remain muted at all times during the match, except during Tactical Pauses.

Failure to comply with these restrictions or abuse of it may result in the following disciplinary actions:

- Each instance of Coach's failure to comply with 4.8.1. will be sanctioned with at least 1 Minor Warning for breach of Rule "4.8.1 - Coach Communication During Match".
- Each egregious violation of to comply with 4.8.1. will be sanctioned with 1 Major Warning for breach of Rule "4.8.1 - Coach Communication During Match", at the discretion of the TO.
- Additional warnings or sanctions, as event disqualification, may be issued based on the severity or intent of the breach.

#### **4.10.2. Coach Broadcast**

Players may provide their coach with a private match stream for tactical purposes. This stream must:

- Be strictly limited to the team's staff
- Not be broadcasted, shared, or accessed by unauthorized individuals

Unauthorized access or distribution of the stream is a serious breach and may result in penalties, including disqualification from the event.

#### **4.11. Nicknames**

Players are obligated to use nicknames their team representative left in the form provided by tournament organizers and are no longer able to change it without an approval from the TO, failure to do so may result in penalties. Player names must not include mentioning of any sponsors or language that is not approved by Tournament Officials.

#### **4.12. Team Names**

Team names must align with those listed on recognized public platforms such as HLTV and Liquipedia.

- Any deviations from these names require prior approval from CCT.
- Inclusion of sponsor names in team titles is strictly prohibited unless explicitly authorized by CCT.
- Team names must not contain any racist, sexist, discriminatory, or otherwise offensive language.

CCT reserves the right to approve, reject, or demand changes to any team name at its sole discretion.

### **4.13. Team Photos and Logotypes**

Each team must provide player photos and a team logo with a transparent background to be used during the broadcast.

Dimensions:

- Player Photos: 500×500 PNG
- Team Logo: 500×500 and 120×120 SVG format

CCT reserves the right to reject any Player Photo or Team Logo that does not meet the specified requirements, violates tournament rules, or is deemed inappropriate by common standards.

### **4.14. Media Obligations**

Teams are obligated to comply with any reasonable media requests the CCT may have, in order to uphold or raise the standards of the broadcast, tournament promotion and marketing. By participating, teams accept to promote the tournament itself on their team and personal pages, including social media.

#### **4.14.1 Camera Obligations**

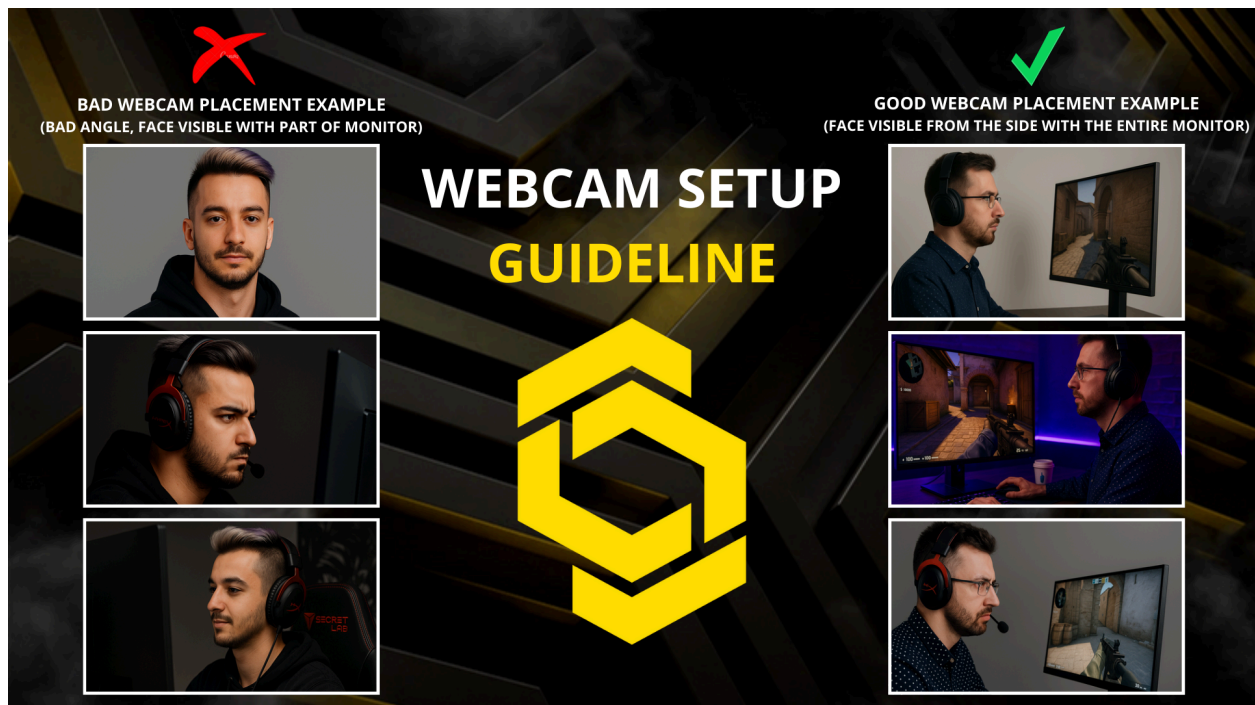
For each Series, upon request from the CCT, each player must provide a clean, unobstructed camera feed for the broadcast. The following apply:

- Players must activate their cameras at least twenty (20) minutes before the scheduled match starts.
- Cameras may be turned off between maps, but must be reactivated no later than five (5) minutes before the next map begins.
- Smoking or vaping on camera is strictly prohibited.

Failure to comply with camera obligations may result in verbal warnings, fines, or a technical loss.

#### **4.14.2 Camera Setup Guidelines**

All players must follow the Camera Setup Guidelines provided by CCT unless otherwise approved. Before each stage where camera use is mandatory, CCT will distribute the latest guidelines. Standard expectations are illustrated in the example image below:



Deviations must be pre-approved by CCT.

#### 4.14.3 Integrity Requirements

For integrity purposes, CCT reserves the right to require players to have their cameras on during a match, even if the footage is not used in the broadcast. In cases where a team refuses to activate private cameras (used solely for integrity, not for broadcast), CCT reserves the right to award a technical loss on the grounds of an integrity breach.

#### 4.14.4 Penalties

Failure to adhere to any of the Camera Obligations, Setup Guidelines or Integrity Requirements can lead to penalties:

- 1-2 members of the lineup without camera: 5% of the prize money winnings
- 3-4 members of the lineup without camera: 15% of the prize money winnings
- 5-6 members of the line-up without camera: 15% of the prize money winnings and a Major warning

Additional Penalties:

- In cases where a team refuses to activate private cameras (used solely for integrity, not for broadcast), CCT reserves the right to award a technical loss on the grounds of an integrity breach.
- While on camera smoking in any sort, including vape, is strictly forbidden. This can lead to a Verbal Warning, Fine or a Technical Loss.

Please refer to section 3 of this Rulebook for more details on warnings and other penalties.  
The above stated rule is only valid if Tournament Officials specified it on the CCT Discord or by email.

#### **4.15 Schedule Requests**

Teams may request schedule adjustments or communicate potential scheduling conflicts to CCT. Such requests may include, but are not limited to, preferred match times, availability limitations, event clashes, travel commitments, or other logistical constraints.

All schedule requests must be submitted via the Team Discord Channel and include all relevant information (e.g. preference, conflict, and/or reasoning). CCT will review all requests and reserves the right to approve or deny them at its sole discretion. Schedule adjustments are not guaranteed unless explicitly confirmed by CCT.

A schedule request is not considered approved unless explicitly confirmed by CCT. Where an adjustment can be guaranteed, CCT will clearly communicate it as confirmed.

##### **4.15.1. Schedule Request Timing**

Teams are responsible for submitting schedule requests within the following timeframes:

- Pre-Event (Invite Stage) - Teams may submit schedule requests prior to the start of the Event. This is the preferred stage for any requests.
- During the Event – Schedule requests must be submitted no later than forty-eight (48) hours prior to the team's scheduled match. Requests submitted within 48 hours of a match will be declined.

Any requests made after the publication of the daily schedule will be denied.

##### **4.15.2. Schedule Request Compliance**

Teams are solely responsible for identifying and communicating any scheduling conflicts within the defined timelines.

CCT reserves the right to approve or deny any schedule request at its sole discretion and is under no obligation to provide justification. Schedule requests are non-binding unless explicitly confirmed by CCT.

CCT assumes no responsibility for declined requests or any resulting consequences, including but not limited to match forfeits, loss of VRS points, or other applicable penalties. By participating in a CCT Event, teams unconditionally accept the official schedule as published by CCT.

Any attempt to pressure, expedite, or circumvent CCT's operational timelines for schedule-related requests may result in disciplinary action, including warnings, fines, or match penalties, at CCT's sole discretion.

## **4.16. Matches**

### **4.16.1. Punctuality**

All matches in CCT shall start as confirmed by the tournament Officials in the Tournaments' Discord channel.

- The team captain (or designated representative responsible for the map veto) must be present and ready to begin the veto process 30 minutes prior to the scheduled match start time.
- If a team is not present or not ready to begin the veto process at that time, the team will be granted a 10 minute grace period to appear and participate in the veto process (Up to 20 minutes prior to the scheduled match start time).
- All players must be connected to the server and ready to play no later than 10 minutes prior to the scheduled match start time.
- There will be a 15 minute break between maps in a series, and at least 15 minutes break between separate series in case any delays in the schedule should occur, unless approved otherwise by the Tournament Officials.

Failure to appear or respond for the veto process within the required timeframe (Grace period) will result in forfeiture of veto. Tournament Officials reserve the right to proceed with the veto without the absent team.

In such cases, the veto decisions for the non-responsive team may be determined using an automated or randomized method at the discretion of the Tournament Officials, including the use of third-party randomization tools or platforms, such as but not limited to random.org.

Any delays must be communicated promptly to Tournament Officials. CCT reserves the right to approve or deny any delay request at its sole discretion and is under no obligation to provide justification.

### **4.16.2. Delaying the Match**

Teams are expected to be ready to begin their matches at the scheduled start time. Any delay of up to fifteen (15) minutes may result in warnings or penalties at the discretion of Tournament Officials.

Delays beyond this threshold will result in technical losses, depending on the match format:

- Best-of-1 (BO1): A delay exceeding 15 minutes will result in a technical loss (13-0 score) for the delaying team.
- Best-of-3 (BO3):
  - After 15 minutes: the first map will be declared a technical loss (13-0 score). If this results in a 2-0 score, the series will be concluded.
  - After 30 minutes: the entire series will be forfeited (2 Map losses awarded).
- Best-of-5 (BO5):
  - After 15 minutes: Map 1 is forfeited (13-0 Loss).
  - After 30 minutes: Map 2 is forfeited (13-0 Loss).



- After 45 minutes: Map 3 is forfeited, resulting in 3 map losses being awarded and conclusion of the match.

All delays must be reported to Tournament Officials via the official Discord channel. CCT reserves the right to allow or deny extensions on the above threshold and to apply additional sanctions in the event of repeated infractions or integrity concerns.

#### **4.16.3 Technical Problems during the Match**

- If the player is responsive (switching to a backup connection, runs into anticheat issues, has a blackout that is expected to be short-term or there's a backup grid to be switched to, is able to travel to a new location like PC cafe within the time limit):
  - Allow up to 30 minutes of tech break for the player to reconnect. This technical pause time is allocated per team for the entire match, regardless of the number of incidents or players affected.
  - If the player is still unable to reconnect after 30 minutes, the match may proceed 4v5 only if:
    - The team has scored 10 or more rounds, or
    - The team is leading by 6 or more rounds, or
    - If the above conditions are not met, but it is determined - based on objective game state factors (example: current score, economy, momentum) - that the team still has a realistic competitive chance, the Tournament Officials may allow the match to proceed 4v5.
  - If none of the above apply, the map is recorded as a technical loss.
- If the player is unresponsive (no communication can be established, no evidence of their PC being operational, no estimation of the time required to resolve the issue):
  - Allow up to 15 minutes of tech break for the player to reconnect. This time also contributes to the total technical pause limit per team for the match.
  - If the player is still unable to reconnect after 15 minutes, the match may proceed 4v5 only if:
    - The team has scored 10 or more rounds, or
    - The team is leading by 6 or more rounds, or
    - If the above conditions are not met, but it is determined - based on objective game state factors (example: current score, economy, momentum) - that the team still has a realistic competitive chance, the Tournament Officials may allow the match to proceed 4v5.
  - If none of the above apply, the map is recorded as a technical loss.

#### **4.16.4. Restarting a map**

In limited cases where a player disconnects early in a map, a full map restart may be granted to allow for a replacement. The following conditions must all be met:

- No more than five (5) rounds have been played.
- The impacted team is the only team to have won any rounds.
- The replacement player follows rules 4.6. Stand-in Rules and all applicable VRS Core rules.

- The team must request the restart within the first fifteen (15) minutes of their Technical Pause.
- If thirty (30) minutes of total Technical Pause time is reached and the team is still not ready to resume, the map will be forfeited.
- A Team can only restart 1 map per match. Repeated map restarts are not allowed.

CCT reserves the right to deny any restart request, regardless of circumstances.

Abuse of this rule may result in penalties ranging from official warnings to disqualification, depending on the severity of the violation.

#### **4.16.5. Forfeiting a match**

In case a team forfeits a match, any unplayed maps are recorded as a 13:0 loss. The team winning a match as a result of a forfeit does not earn any round difference besides the maps that have been played to completion.

With the Tournament Officials permission the forfeiting team might proceed playing in the event unless they got eliminated as a result of the forfeit. Depending on the reasoning and the circumstances that led to the forfeit the Officials will issue an oral warning, a minor or a major warning, or a complete disqualification of a team.

Forfeiting multiple matches during a single event leads to a more significant penalty. Forfeiting a match might lead to a team not getting invited to the future CCT events.

#### **4.17. Team Sponsorships**

All team sponsors displayed on player shirts or other apparel must comply with applicable laws, Terms of Service of any broadcast platform (Twitch, YouTube, Kick), and the policies of Valve Corporation. Sponsors deemed, at the reasonable discretion of the organizers, to breach these requirements or to otherwise be inappropriate, may be required to be removed or concealed prior to participation in the tournament.

For avoidance of doubt teams must confirm approval with the Tournament Officials.

## **5. Game-specific Rules**

### **5.1. Server settings**

- Startmoney: \$800
- Maxround: 24
- Roundtime: 1m 55s (1.92)
- Freezetime: 20s
- C4 timer: 40s
- Timeout: 3×30 seconds each map
- Overtime:
- Best of 6 rounds - \$12.500 startmoney
- 1×30 seconds timeout per overtime

## **5.2. Match Platform**

Matches will be hosted using a match platform selected by the TO. All participants shall ensure to have a registered account on the platform before signing up to the competition. All the participants should follow the platform rulebook unless it contradicts the Official CCT Rulebook

### **5.2.1. Game Server Location**

The match platform will offer a selection of server locations available for the teams to choose from. Should a team be deemed to deliberately pick a location that puts the other team at a disadvantage or should the teams be unable to come to an agreement regarding the server location, the organizer reserves the right to select a location in good faith.

### **5.2.2. Available Server Commands**

- .ready - set the team as ready to start the knife round or match, both teams must be ready
- .notready / .unready - set the team as not ready to start the knife round or match
- .stay - do not change sides after the knife round
- .switch / .swap - change sides after the knife round
- .tech - call for a technical pause
- .tac - call for a tactical pause
- .unpause - unpause the match, both teams must be ready
- .continue - continue the match after the round is restored

## **5.3. Map Pool**

The following maps are used for the CCT tournament (Valve official versions). The map pool will follow the official Active Duty Map pool as defined by Valve, and therefore might be updated before each tournament phase.

### **5.3.1. Maps**

CCT will utilise the Active Duty Map Pool as designated by Valve.

- Inferno
- Nuke
- Dust 2
- Ancient
- Mirage
- Overpass
- Anubis

## **5.4. Map Selection**

Map veto is held on discord in the match channel 30 minutes before the scheduled start time with the teams assigned as Team A and Team B through coin toss.

#### **5.4.1. Best-Of-One Map Veto**

- Team A bans a map
- Team B bans a map
- Team A bans a map
- Team B bans a map
- Team A bans a map
- Team B bans a map
- The remaining map will be played.

#### **5.4.2. Best-Of-Three Map Veto**

- Team A bans a map
- Team B bans a map
- Team A picks a map (Team B picks side)
- Team B picks a map (Team A picks side)
- Team A bans a map
- Team B bans a map
- The remaining map will be decider. (Knife round will be played)

#### **5.4.3. Best-Of-Five Map Veto**

- Team A bans a map
- Team B bans a map
- Team A picks a map (Team B picks side)
- Team B picks a map (Team A picks side)
- Team A picks a map (Team B picks side)
- Team B picks a map (Team A picks side)
- The remaining map will be decider.

### **5.5. In-game Behavior**

#### **5.5.1. Forbidden Scripts and In-game Actions**

The following actions are strictly prohibited during the tournament. Violations may result in penalties which can include, but are not limited to, warnings, fines, round losses, map forfeits, or match forfeits, depending on severity and the judgement of Tournament Officials.

1. Using pause during a round (except for technical problems at the end of a round or during freeze time).
2. Any form of script is forbidden excluding standard buy binds and jump-throw scripts.
3. Exploiting bugs that alter core game mechanics (e.g., spawn bugs).
4. Moving through walls, floors, or roofs, including skywalking.
5. Silent bomb planting (planting a bomb without the correct audio cue).

6. Planting the bomb in a way that makes it impossible to defuse.
7. Boosting with teammates is allowed unless it causes textures, walls, ceilings, or floors to become transparent or penetrable.
8. Throwing flashbangs under walls is not allowed. Throwing grenades over walls or roofs is permitted.
9. The use of any custom or modified game files.

### **5.5.2. Issues during the Match**

If a match is interrupted for reasons beyond the control of the teams (e.g., player crash, server crash, or network failure), the Match Officials may order a round replay or match restoration under the following conditions:

1. Before the first kill of a round: The round will be replayed.
2. After the first kill of a round:
  - a. If the outcome of the round can be clearly determined, it will stand.
  - b. If the outcome cannot be clearly determined, the round will be replayed unless Tournament Officials decide otherwise at their discretion.
  - c. Teams must continue playing until instructed otherwise by Match Officials.
3. Start money and dropped players:
  - a. If a player disconnects and start money is applied, a round restore will be used to ensure the correct economy.
  - b. If the round restore fails, the demo file will be used to determine and correct the economy.
4. Unsuccessful round restore:
  - a. During the first three (3) rounds: If a server crash occurs during the first three rounds, the match will be restarted.
  - b. After the first three (3) rounds: If a crash occurs after the first three rounds, the match will resume from the latest valid round restore backup.
    - i. Any missing rounds will be emulated under Tournament Official supervision, with players replicating kills, purchases, and grenade usage as instructed.

### **5.5.3. Recordings**

Players are not required to record in-game demos unless instructed by Tournament Officials. All matches will be recorded via GOTV.

Teams must use the official TeamSpeak server provided by the Tournament Organizer to ensure competitive integrity.

- Each team may have five players and one coach in their TeamSpeak channel during live gameplay.
- A manager, analyst, or assistant coach may join only during breaks between maps and must leave before the next map begins.

All voice communications will be recorded. These recordings will not be made publicly available. Teams may request access to their own voice comms, which will be provided through the Tournament Officials.

#### **5.5.4. Anti-Cheat Ban**

If any participant in the CCT receives a ban from the publisher's anti-cheat system (e.g., Valve Anti-Cheat) or any recognized tournament platform anti-cheat (e.g., FACEIT Anti-Cheat, Akros Anti-Cheat), they will be immediately disqualified from all remaining matches of the Event. Tournament Officials may apply additional penalties if required to maintain competitive integrity.

#### **5.5.5. Anti-Cheat**

All players are required to use Akros Anti-Cheat ([akros.ac](https://akros.ac)) in order to join the match server. Participants must ensure that Akros is correctly installed, updated, and fully operational no later than the day before their first match.

Failure to comply may result in penalties, which may include warnings, fines, round or map forfeits, or disqualification, depending on the severity of the violation and the judgement of Tournament Officials.

## **6. Penalties and Warnings**

Tournament Officials may apply penalties at their discretion when rules are violated. Penalties may include, but are not limited to: warnings, default losses, round or map forfeits, fines, or disqualification of a player or team from the tournament.

### **6.1. Warnings**

A warning may be issued to a player or a team when a rule is broken. A warning issued to a player counts equally toward the team.

There are three types of warnings:

- Verbal Warning: No direct consequences, serves as an official notice.
- Minor Warning
- Major Warning: 3 (three) minor warnings will equal 1 (one) Major Warning

Examples of incidents that may result in a warning:

- Insults or harassment toward opponents or staff
- Disrespectful behavior toward administration
- Rule violations
- Delays without admin approval
- Unsportsmanlike conduct

- Falsifying match results
- Playing with an ineligible or disallowed player
- Misleading admins or other teams
- Cheating or using prohibited scripts/exploits
- Intentional abuse of game bugs

In severe cases, a major warning may be applied immediately.

## **6.2. Major Warnings and Disqualification**

- A major warning can be triggered by the accumulation of three minor warnings or applied immediately in severe cases.
- Multiple major warnings may be applied simultaneously.
- Three major warnings will result in disqualification from the tournament.

Tournament Officials retain full discretion to adjust warnings and penalties to maintain competitive integrity and ensure fair play.

## **6.3. Forfeiting the Veto**

The team captain (or designated representative responsible for the map veto) must be present and ready to begin the veto process 30 minutes prior to the scheduled match start time, as outlined in Rule 4.16.1. Punctuality.

If a team is not present or not ready to begin the veto process at that time, the team will be granted a 5 minute grace period to appear and participate in the veto process (20 minutes prior to the scheduled match start time).

If a team fails to appear, remains unresponsive, or is not ready to participate in the veto process within this timeframe, Tournament Officials reserve the right to execute the veto on their behalf.

This may include:

- Automatic veto decisions ("Auto-Veto"), and/or
- Randomized map picks and bans for the non-responsive team using a neutral randomization method, including third-party tools or platforms such as random.org or equivalent services.

Failure to comply with the veto process within the required timeframe shall be considered forfeiture of veto and acceptance of the resulting veto outcome.

Any veto executed under this rule, including Auto-Veto and randomized outcomes, shall not be subject to review, reversal, or replay.

CCT bears no responsibility for the outcome of any veto executed in accordance with this rule, including any resulting competitive disadvantage. Failure to appear or participate within the required timeframe remains the sole responsibility of the team.

These decisions are final and made to preserve tournament integrity and schedule continuity.

## **6.4. Penalties and Consequences for leaving CCT**

### **6.4.1. Leaving during any phase**

The CCT reserves the right to penalize teams that leave the competition, with penalties applied either immediately or at the next event in which the team participates within 365 days.

- Teams that leave or are disqualified during an ongoing stage, or between stages, forfeit all prize money earned in the current event.

Additional penalties may include suspension from future events or exclusion from invitations, particularly in cases of last-minute withdrawals.

### **6.4.2. Forfeiture of Matches**

If a team leaves or is disqualified during any phase of the tournament, all current and future matches involving that team will be forfeited.

## **7. Code of Conduct**

### **7.1. Competitive Integrity**

Teams and participants are expected to compete at their highest level at all times, upholding sportsmanship, honesty, and fair play. Violations may result in penalties at the discretion of CCT.

#### **7.1.1. Collusion**

Collusion is any cooperation or conspiracy among Players, Teams, and/or Organizations to cheat, deceive, or gain unfair advantage. Examples include, but are not limited to:

- Soft play: Agreement among Players to not compete at a reasonable standard.
- Pre-arranging prize money or compensation distributions.
- Sending or receiving external signals to influence gameplay.
- Deliberately losing a Game for compensation or other benefits.
- Conspiring to predetermine locations for Free Agents and/or conspiring to fix the salaries of contracts for Team Members and/or potential Team Members.

#### **7.1.2. Cheating and Exploiting**

- Hacking or modifying the game client.
- Exploiting in-game bugs to gain an advantage.
- The use of any kind of cheating device and/or cheat program, or any similar cheating method.
- Using another Player's account ("ringing").
- Using any prohibited scripts, cheats, or external devices.
- Looking at spectator monitors or similar unfair advantages.
- Intentional disconnections without valid, explicitly stated reasons.



## 7.2. Responsibility under the Code

All participants are responsible for their actions during the tournament. This includes:

- Intentional and unintentional offenses: All rule violations, attempts to commit violations, or actions that undermine tournament integrity are punishable.
- Harassment: Systematic or repeated hostile acts targeting an individual or group, or a single egregious act that demeans or ostracizes.
- Sexual harassment: Unwelcome sexual advances, coercion, threats, or promises of advantage in exchange for sexual favors.
- Discriminatory behavior: Any contemptuous or denigrating actions based on race, ethnicity, gender, religion, sexual orientation, political opinion, or other protected status.
- Compliance with law: Participants must not engage in activities prohibited by law that could lead to conviction.

## 7.3. Employment and Contract Conduct

Participants and team affiliates must maintain professional integrity regarding contracts and employment:

- May not solicit, hire, or induce Head Coaches or Players under contract with another CCT team.
- May express intent to leave a Team publicly, but may not directly encourage Teams to breach contracts.
- Violations may result in warnings, fines, match forfeits, or disqualification at the discretion of Tournament Officials.

## 7.4. Match and Game Integrity

Participants must preserve the integrity of every match:

- May not offer, agree, or conspire to influence the outcome of a Game or Match in any unlawful or prohibited manner.
- Must comply with all requests from Tournament Officials for documentation, demos, or verification.
- Failure to comply may result in warnings, fines, forfeits, or disqualification.

## Annex 1 Country List

| South America | Europe     |         |         |
|---------------|------------|---------|---------|
| Argentina     | Albania    | Armenia | Austria |
| Bolivia       | Azerbaijan | Belarus | Belgium |

|                     |                        |                 |                |
|---------------------|------------------------|-----------------|----------------|
| Brazil              | Bosnia and Herzegovina | Bulgaria        | Croatia        |
| Chile               | Cyprus                 | Czech Republic  | Denmark        |
| Colombia            | Estonia                | Finland         | France         |
| Ecuador             | Georgia                | Germany         | Greece         |
| Falkland Island     | Hungary                | Iceland         | Ireland        |
| French Guiana       | Italy                  | Kazakhstan      | Kyrgyzstan     |
| Guyana              | Kosovo                 | Latvia          | Lithuania      |
| Paraguay            | Luxembourg             | Malta           | Moldova        |
| Peru                | Netherlands            | North Macedonia | Norway         |
| Suriname            | Poland                 | Portugal        | Romania        |
| Trinidad and Tobago | Russia                 | Serbia          | Slovakia       |
| Uruguay             | Slovenia               | Spain           | Sweden         |
| Venezuela           | Switzerland            | Tajikistan      | Turkey         |
|                     | Turkmenistan           | Ukraine         | United Kingdom |
|                     | Uzbekistan             |                 |                |